

Matrix multiplication

$$A \cdot B = ?$$

- more complicated
- motivation will become clear later

Product only defined if # columns in A = # rows in B

$$\begin{pmatrix} & \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} & \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} & \end{pmatrix}$$

$A \qquad B \qquad C$
 $m \times n \quad p \times q \quad m \times q$



need $n = p$

Example

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & a_{13} & a_{14} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & a_{23} & a_{24} \\ a_{31} & a_{32} & a_{33} & a_{34} \end{pmatrix} & \begin{pmatrix} b_{11} & b_{12} \\ b_{21} & b_{22} \\ b_{31} & b_{32} \\ b_{41} & b_{42} \end{pmatrix} & = \begin{pmatrix} c_{11} & c_{12} \\ c_{21} & c_{22} \\ c_{31} & c_{32} \end{pmatrix} \\ \textcolor{blue}{A} & \textcolor{blue}{B} & \textcolor{blue}{C} \\ 3 \times \underline{4} & \underline{4} \times 2 & 3 \times 2 \\ & \textcolor{red}{\leftarrow \text{equal} \rightarrow} & \end{array}$$

dot product


$$\begin{aligned} c_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{1}} &= (\text{row } \textcolor{brown}{1} \text{ of } A) \cdot (\text{column } \textcolor{yellow}{1} \text{ of } B) \\ &= a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{1}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{1}} + a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}} + a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{3}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{3}} + a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{4}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{4}} \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^4 a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{k}}b_{\textcolor{yellow}{k}\textcolor{yellow}{1}} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} c_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}} &= (\text{row } \textcolor{brown}{1} \text{ of } A) \cdot (\text{column } \textcolor{yellow}{2} \text{ of } B) \\ &= a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{1}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}} + a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}} + a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{3}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}} + a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{4}}b_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{2}} \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^4 a_{\textcolor{brown}{1}\textcolor{yellow}{k}}b_{\textcolor{yellow}{k}\textcolor{yellow}{2}} \end{aligned}$$

$$c_{\textcolor{brown}{2}\textcolor{yellow}{1}} = (\text{row } \textcolor{brown}{2} \text{ of } A) \cdot (\text{column } \textcolor{yellow}{1} \text{ of } B)$$

Example

$$\begin{pmatrix} 3 & 4 \\ 2 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 10 \\ 0 & 6 \end{pmatrix}$$

Check your calculations with
Octave/Matlab or similar!

Matrix multiplication is not commutative!

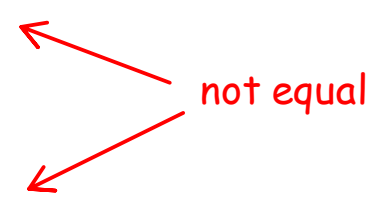
I.e., in general $AB \neq BA$

To show that matrix multiplication is not commutative, one counterexample is enough.

Take for instance:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$A \qquad B$



not equal

But

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

$B \qquad A$

Other example:

$$(1 \quad 2 \quad 3) \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} = (14)$$

A
 1×3

B
 3×1

1×1

not equal

But

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} (1 \quad 2 \quad 3) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 2 & 4 & 6 \\ 3 & 6 & 9 \end{pmatrix}$$

A
 1×3

B
 3×1

3×3

Always keep the order when multiplying matrices!

Theorem For all matrices A , B , and C ,

- | | | |
|-----|----------------------|------------------------|
| (1) | $A(B + C) = AB + AC$ | left distributive law |
| | | check on your own! |
| (2) | $(A + B)C = AC + BC$ | right distributive law |
| | | check on your own! |
| (3) | $A(BC) = (AB)C$ | associative law |

Proof (1) and (2) are relatively straightforward..

Proof of (3) (associativity):

Let A be $m \times n$, B be $n \times p$, and C be $p \times q$.

We want to show that $A(BC) = (AB)C$.

To this end, we show that for all i, j :

$$(A(BC))_{ij} = ((AB)C)_{ij}$$

entry in row i , column j of
 $(AB)C$

By definition of matrix multiplication, we have

$$\begin{aligned}(A(BC))_{ij} &= \sum_{k=1}^n a_{ik} \underbrace{\left(\sum_{\ell=1}^p b_{k\ell} c_{\ell j} \right)}_{(BC)_{kj}} = \sum_{k=1}^n \sum_{\ell=1}^p a_{ik} b_{k\ell} c_{\ell j} \\ &= \sum_{\ell=1}^p \sum_{k=1}^n a_{ik} b_{k\ell} c_{\ell j} = \sum_{\ell=1}^p c_{\ell j} \underbrace{\left(\sum_{k=1}^n a_{ik} b_{k\ell} \right)}_{(AB)_{i\ell}} \\ &= \sum_{\ell=1}^p \underbrace{\left(\sum_{k=1}^n a_{ik} b_{k\ell} \right)}_{(AB)_{i\ell}} c_{\ell j} \\ &= ((AB)C)_{ij}\end{aligned}$$



Now let's see various important "alternative ways" of carrying out matrix multiplication.

First, let's look at the extremely important special case where one of the two matrices is a vector.

a.) "matrix · column vector"

Example

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} = \text{column vector}$$

A x

by definition,

$$Ax = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 \\ 1 \cdot 4 + (-1) \cdot 5 + 2 \cdot 6 \\ 1 \cdot 7 + (-1) \cdot 8 + 2 \cdot 9 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ 11 \\ 17 \end{pmatrix}$$

Often, the following way of doing the multiplication is more convenient:

$$Ax = 1 \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 4 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix} + (-1) \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \\ 8 \end{pmatrix} + 2 \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 6 \\ 9 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ 11 \\ 17 \end{pmatrix}$$

Here, Ax is written as a linear combination (weighted sum) of the columns of A . The entries in x determine how the columns are weighted in the weighted sum.

This view of "matrix * column vector" multiplication is particularly convenient if there are (many) zero entries in x :

Example

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} = 1 \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 4 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix} + (-1) \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \\ 8 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ -1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

A x

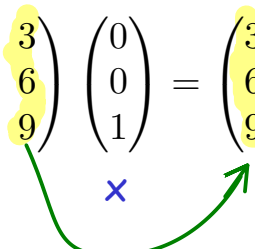
"First column - second column"

Here even more useful:

Example

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 6 \\ 9 \end{pmatrix}$$

A x



multiplication just "grabs the third column of A "

b.) What about "matrix · row vector"?

Example

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 7 & -9 \end{pmatrix} =$$

undefined!

c.) "row vector · matrix"

Example

$$(1 \quad -1 \quad 0) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} = (-3 \quad -3 \quad -3)$$

γ A

← equal
↓

We can view this multiplication as a linear combination (weighed sum) of the rows of A :

$$1 \cdot (1 \quad 2 \quad 3) + (-1) \cdot (4 \quad 5 \quad 6) + 0 \cdot (7 \quad 8 \quad 9) = (-3 \quad -3 \quad -3)$$

d.) What about "column vector · matrix"?

Example

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -3 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 7 & 8 & 9 \end{pmatrix} =$$

undefined!

General matrix multiplication (two arbitrary matrices)

Column by column

$$\begin{pmatrix} & & & & \end{pmatrix}_{\substack{A \\ m \times n}} \begin{pmatrix} \boxed{} \\ \end{pmatrix}_{\substack{B \\ n \times p}} = \begin{pmatrix} \boxed{} \\ \end{pmatrix}_{\substack{C \\ m \times p}}$$

We can determine the product "column by column" with p "matrix * column vector" multiplications:

$$\text{"column } j \text{ of } C" = A \cdot \text{"column } j \text{ of } B"$$

Example

$$\underset{\text{A}}{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 5 \end{pmatrix}} \underset{\text{B}}{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}} = \underset{\text{C}}{\begin{pmatrix} ? & ? \\ ? & ? \end{pmatrix}}$$

First column of the product:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 5 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} = 1 \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} + 0 \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} + 0 \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

first column of A

Second column of the product:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 5 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = 0 \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} + 1 \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} + 1 \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 9 \end{pmatrix}$$

sum of last two columns of A

Hence

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 5 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 9 \end{pmatrix}$$

→

We see that the columns of C are linear combinations (weighted sums) of the columns of A

We can also compute row-by row:

Row by row

$$\begin{pmatrix} \boxed{} \\ \\ \\ \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \\ \\ \\ \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \boxed{} \\ \\ \\ \end{pmatrix}$$

A B C
 $m \times n$ $n \times p$ $m \times p$

We can determine the product "row by row" with m "row vector * matrix" multiplications:

$$\text{"row } i \text{ of } C" = \text{"row } i \text{ of } A" \cdot B$$

Example

$$\underset{\text{A}}{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 5 \end{pmatrix}} \underset{\text{B}}{\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}} = \underset{\text{C}}{\begin{pmatrix} ? \\ \end{pmatrix}}$$

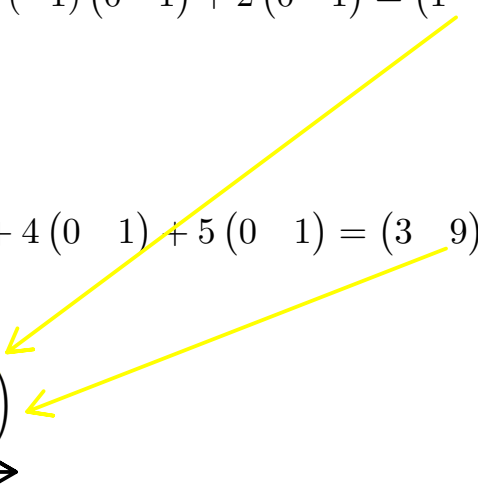
First row of the product:

$$(1 \quad -1 \quad 2) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = 1(1 \quad 0) + (-1)(0 \quad 1) + 2(0 \quad 1) = (1 \quad 1)$$

Second row of the product:

$$(3 \quad 4 \quad 5) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = 3(1 \quad 0) + 4(0 \quad 1) + 5(0 \quad 1) = (3 \quad 9)$$

Hence

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 & 5 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 9 \end{pmatrix}$$


We see that the rows of C are linear combinations (weighted sums) of the rows of B

Identity matrices

Definition

The identity matrix I_n is an $n \times n$ matrix with 1 on the diagonal and 0 everywhere else.

$$I_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad I_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{etc.}$$

Fact If A is an $m \times n$ matrix then

$$I_m A = A = A I_n.$$

Example

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 5 & 4 & 7 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 5 & 4 & 7 \end{pmatrix}$$

A I_3 A



Identity matrices of different sizes needed.

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 5 & 4 & 7 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 5 & 4 & 7 \end{pmatrix}$$

I_2 A A



Check using any of the matrix multiplication "methods"! Which one is most convenient in each case?

Sometimes Useful:

Fact If AB is defined then $(AB)^T = B^T A^T$.

Change of order!



Proof: [Tutorial 1](#)